

Differentiation – Product Rule: Worked Examples

Product Rule

If $y = uv$ where u and v are functions of x , then

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = u \frac{dv}{dx} + v \frac{du}{dx}$$

Example

Differentiate:

$$y = 2x \sin x$$

$$u = 2x; \quad \frac{du}{dx} = 2$$

$$v = \sin x; \quad \frac{dv}{dx} = \cos x$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = 2x(\cos x) + \sin x(2)$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = 2x \cos x + 2 \sin x$$

This could be factorised to

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = 2(x \cos x + \sin x)$$